Fennel and the Big Orange Scared

A story about feeling scared

by KUZU NOHA

Fennel and the Big Orange Scared

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For every little bear
with a big feeling.

It was bedtime for Fennel, all cozy and warm,

when the sky made a rumble: a storm! A storm!

The wind gave a howl. The rain gave a splash.

Then the whole sky lit up with a great big FLASH!

BOOM! went the thunder, rolling along.

Fennel's heart went thump,
thump, thumping along.

A spark of orange popped into the air.

It grew with each flash,
and it gave him a scare.

It fizzed and it flickered
and filled up the room—

the Big Orange Scared,
going BOOM, BOOM, BOOM!

“Mama!” called Fennel.
“I’m scared of the sound!”

Mama Bear hurried and wrapped her arms round.

“First, SNUGGLE in close,
with your blanket and me,

cozy and warm as a bear can be.”

“Next, COUNT when you see a flash in the sky.

One, two, three... BOOM!
See the storm rolling by."

“The numbers get bigger.
The thunder gets small.

The storm is moving off. It’s not here at all.”

“Last, SHINE a small light. Look all around.”

His flashlight showed
toys, with no scary sound.

The orange spark shrank to a tiny warm glow,

like a firefly’s light, going soft, going slow.

Now when the thunder
goes BOOM in the night,

Fennel knows: Snuggle. Count. Shine his light.

Fennel's 3 Brave Steps

1. SNUGGLE

Get cozy with a blanket and a hug.

2. COUNT

Count the seconds from flash to boom.

3. SHINE

Shine a small light and look around.

Scared is okay.

Thunder is only a big noise.

A Note for Grown-Ups

Name the feeling: “You feel scared.”

Stay calm and close. Say: “It is only thunder.”

Count the seconds together and
watch the storm move away.

Offer a small flashlight. Praise every brave step.

Thank you for reading!

If Fennel helped your little one, a short review on Amazon helps other families find this book.